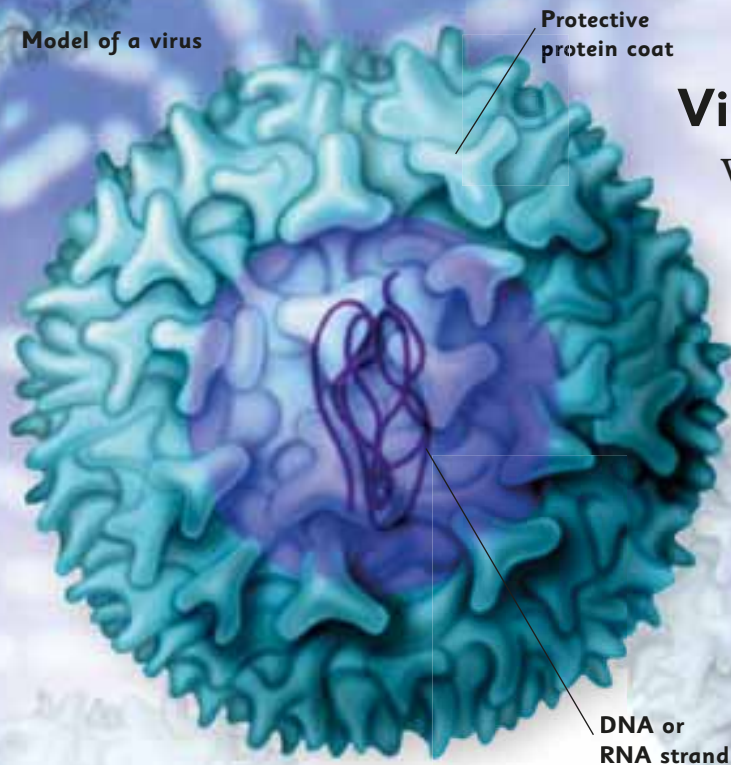


Model of a virus



Protective protein coat

Viruses

Viruses are many times smaller than bacteria. They are shaped like spheres or rods. Viruses are not really alive, because they are not made of cells. They only become active when they invade a cell. They copy themselves by taking over the cell and turning it into a virus factory.

Plant viruses

Plant viruses can change the way that plants develop. For example, one virus affects the pigment in tulips' petals. It stops the pigment from working in some places. This makes the petals look stripy.



A virus has made light patches appear on these leaves.

The streaked patterns on this tulip are caused by a virus.

Vaccinations

Vaccinations can help to protect people from harmful diseases. A person is injected with a weakened form of a virus or bacterium. This helps the immune system defend itself against the real thing.



Harmful viruses

Viruses can cause different illnesses.



Chickenpox is easy to catch. The main symptom is spots that itch.



Rabies is a fatal virus that is common in animals such as dogs.



Colds are viruses and can bring on a sore throat, runny nose, and cough.



Protists

Protists are another kind of single-celled life form. They are very varied. Some protists are similar to fungi, animals, or plants. Some protists group together into colonies.